



PAPUA NEW GUINEA

POLESTAR INSIGHTS

REPORTING PERIOD: 20 JULY 2026 - 26 JULY 2026

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BOTTOM LINE UP FRONT

The most serious validated development in Papua New Guinea was kama sda student found dead; police investigate alleged murder on 22 July 2026. The period also brought one of two Baisu escapees shot dead and pacific Towings Tugboat rescues passengers off Madang in Madang. During the reporting period, maritime and violent crime events were the main concerns, recorded in Madang, Enga and National Capital District rather than concentrated in a single centre, with the remainder unlocated. Reporting volume fell compared with the previous period. For operations, the immediate significance is that the lead event bears directly on staff safety and journey planning around the affected area.

TOP 3 DEVELOPMENTS

KAMA SDA STUDENT FOUND DEAD; POLICE INVESTIGATE ALLEGED MURDER: Homicide / violent crime · Reported 22 Jul 2026 · EMTV (PNG) For operators, an event of this kind bears directly on staff safety and journey planning around the affected area.	HIGH
One of two Baisu escapees shot dead Homicide / violent crime · Reported 21 Jul 2026 · NBC PNG For operators, an event of this kind bears directly on staff safety and journey planning around the affected area.	HIGH
Pacific Towings Tugboat rescues passengers off Madang Other security · Madang · Reported 26 Jul 2026 · Post-Courier For operators, an event of this kind affects port calls and sea freight through the waters or ports involved.	LOW

CURRENT SITUATION

Security incidents in Papua New Guinea during the reporting period were concentrated in Madang, Enga and National Capital District, with the remainder unlocated. Maritime and violent crime were the principal concerns. The incidents do not currently form a single nationwide pattern; risk varies by location, and movement decisions should be based on current conditions at the destination.

OTHER OPERATIONAL DISRUPTION

Operational disruption to transport, utilities or connectivity was reported, including other security, aviation and maritime, concentrated in Madang. The most serious reported was Wasaeya Elementary Classroom damaged in alleged arson incident, assessed as High severity. Reporting of this activity picked up against the previous week. This reporting is most relevant to transport, power, communications and the operations that depend on them. Disruption of this kind can interrupt operations, logistics and connectivity.

CRIME, THEFT & ROBBERY

Crime, theft and violent incidents were reported, including violent crime and communal violence, concentrated in Enga. The most serious reported was Community education and grief counselling key to end sorcery-related violence in PNG, Catholic priest says, assessed as High severity. Reporting of this activity eased against the previous week. This reporting is most relevant to staff safety, premises, vehicles and the secure movement of cash and assets. Incidents of this kind threaten staff, premises and the movement of cash and assets.

GOVERNANCE & REGULATORY

Policing, regulatory and governance-related activity was reported, including policing operation, reported across several areas without a single focus. The most serious reported was Operation ‘Rausim Illegal Gambling’ nets 65 arrests in WHP and Jiwaka, assessed as Moderate severity. Reporting of this activity eased against the previous week. This reporting is most relevant to permits, compliance, checkpoints and freedom of movement. Regulatory, policing and governance friction can affect compliance, permits and freedom of movement.

RECOMMENDED ACTIONS

MOVEMENT

- Confirm current route conditions before travel into affected districts.
- Avoid non-essential after-hours movement where recent violence has occurred.
- Allow extra travel time where police activity or local gatherings are reported.

SITE SECURITY

- Review access arrangements at sites close to reported incidents.
- Confirm after-hours escalation procedures with guards and site managers.
- Check that emergency contacts and reporting lines remain current.

STAFF AWARENESS

- Brief affected staff on specific locations and current restrictions.
- Reinforce immediate reporting of roadblocks, violence or police activity.
- Share only verified areas to avoid.

TRANSPORT AND LOGISTICS

- Confirm airport, port and road status before affected movements.

OUTLOOK: NEXT SEVEN DAYS

Maritime is likely to remain the main concern during the next seven days. Madang, Papua New Guinea and Enga should remain under review because incidents were reported there during the period. Reporting volume fell compared with the previous period. The coming days should be judged against that direction rather than any single event.

ESCALATION INDICATORS

- Larger or coordinated protest mobilisation, or labour action spreading to key sites and corridors
- Further casualty-bearing or higher-severity violence close to staffed premises
- Spread of incidents beyond Madang and Enga into new districts

POLESTAR VIEW

This period the reporting that carried real weight was violent crime; the rest of the week's items were routine by comparison. Weighed together, the week's reporting bears most on both movement planning and the safety of staff and premises, and that is where checks will pay off first. On assessment, the risk is localised and varies by location, and it is best managed through location-specific decisions rather than

country-wide measures. The key judgement is that maritime drives the current concern, while other categories contributed limited, separate disruption. Businesses should prioritise verified route and site information for Madang and Enga over broad precautionary measures.

Operational Map

Reported operational issues this period



Points show reported events at the town or province named in the reporting; where several share a location one marker carries the count. A marker is a town or province-level fix, not an exact point.

Map Read

This map shows reported operationally relevant issues for the current reporting period. Not every security or crime incident creates commercial impact. Direct impact is used only where reporting shows a current or confirmed effect on operations, movement, access, site security, utilities, production, logistics, workforce safety or business continuity. Indirect impact marks issues relevant to the operating environment with no confirmed effect on a client site, route, workforce, movement, production, access, utilities or logistics. Background incidents, preparedness meetings, isolated crime, political or legal developments, corruption investigations and general policing are Monitor only unless a clear operational effect is reported.

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